

Planning and Design and Access Statement

in respect of an application seeking detailed consent
(self-build project)
for

a detached dwelling and garage

on land adjacent to

3 Brickfield Cottages
East Cowes Road
East Cowes
PO32 6NH



CONTENTS

1. INTRODUCTION
2. SITE HISTORY
3. THE PROPOSAL
4. PLANNING POLICY CONTEXT
5. PLANNING JUSTIFICATION
6. PLANNING BALANCE/CONCLUSION

APPENDICES

- A - Highways pre app advice
- B - Tree report
- C – Southern Water response

1. INTRODUCTION

- 1.1 This statement has been prepared to support a planning application, which seeks consent for the construction of a single detached two bedroomed dwelling and detached garage on land adjacent 3 Brickfield Cottages, as a self-build project.
- 1.2 The relevant history of the site is explained as a background to the interpretation and implementation of planning policy in this particular area.
- 1.3 Relevant national and local planning policies are referred to and the merits of the application discussed in this context.
- 1.4 The application is accompanied by the pre app response of island Roads (Appendix A), a tree report (Appendix B) and Southern Water response (Appendix C).
- 1.5 This application clarifies the status of this scheme as a self-build project by the owner who has inputted into the design of the dwelling prior to submission. This application seeks to establish an approval and clarify that the proposal is to be undertaken as a self-build project and occupied as such.

2. SITE HISTORY

- 2.1 Planning consent granted in August 2022 (21/02386/FUL) for the removal of a caravan and the construction of a detached dwelling. This approval was subject to a unilateral agreement in respect of committing to payments for affordable housing and habitat mitigation contributions.

3. THE PROPOSAL

- 3.1 This submission involves a detailed application seeking planning consent to construct a dwelling and garage on the land adjacent 3 Brickfield Cottages.
- 3.2 The site is served off East Cowes Road, an adopted highway which is a cul de sac accessed off Whippingham Road (A3021).



Site

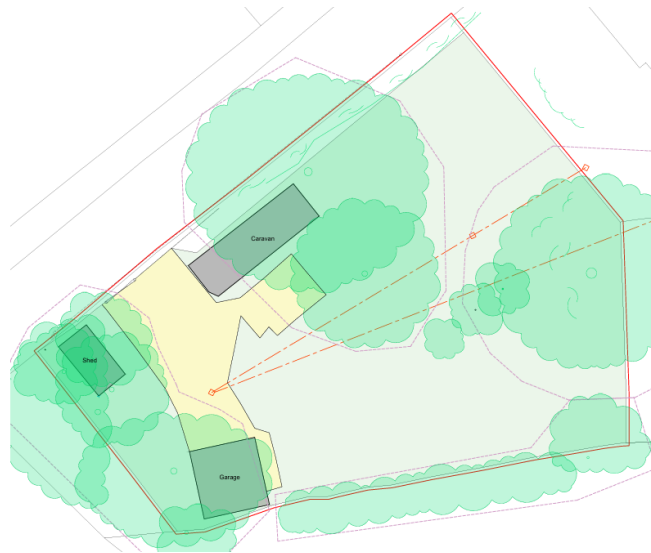
Aerial View

- 3.3 The site currently comprises a separate plot adjacent to 3 Brickfield Cottages containing a static caravan which is to be removed and a small storage outbuilding. The site is well screened by existing vegetation, hedging and tree cover.



Location plan

- 3.4 The property to the north east adjacent the site is a Grade II listed building (3 Brickfield Cottages). The official listing describes this property as one of a range of three cottages built in 1853, designed by the Prince Consort, in Gothic style, to house workers employed by the adjoining Queens brickyard. Built in red brick with stone dressings under slate roofs.



Existing site plan

- 3.5 The scheme seeks to work within the constraints of the site, including the surrounding trees, by constructing a modest dwelling of contemporary design on site with an matching detached garage of high design quality that utilises the potential of the plot size and existing building on site.
- 3.6 The new build will be served off an existing access point providing parking and turning for the dwelling with a compliant access in terms of required visibility whilst meeting adopted parking standards. It would be sited to the rear of the plot utilising the mature tree backdrop.
- 3.7 The property would comprise a kitchen/living/dining room and bedroom at ground floor level with a further bedroom and mezzanine , en-suite and dressing room facilities above. The double garage would be of matching design and materials and provide a home office above for the applicant.



Proposed site plan

- 3.8 The design, siting and external appearance of the dwelling have been developed and considered in the context of the locality and surrounding development to ensure high quality visual impacts whilst positively contributing to the street scene.
- 3.9 In terms of external appearance, the dwelling would comprise larch/cedar cladding with low level Purbeck stone plinth above all under a natural slate roof with anthracite coloured aluminium windows and doors and galvanized steel guttering.



Proposed street scene

4 PLANNING POLICY CONTEXT

- 4.1 In considering application for development the LPA has a statutory duty under Section 38(6) of the Planning and Compulsory Purchase Act 2004 to determine applications in accordance with the development plan i.e., the Island Core Strategy (CS) unless material considerations indicate otherwise. It is also necessary to consider national planning policies which are contained within the National Planning Policy Framework (revised December 2024).

National Planning Policy Framework (revised December 2024)

- 4.2 This document introduces and promotes sustainable development and the need for planning to perform a number of roles, namely an economic, social and environmental. These roles should not be undertaken in isolation.
- 4.3 The NPPF (Paragraph 11) adopts an approach whereby there is a presumption in favour of sustainable development. For decision-taking this means approving development proposals that accord with an up-to-date development plan without

delay; or where the policies which are most important for determining the application are out-of-date, granting permission unless:

“any adverse impacts of doing so would significantly and demonstrably outweigh the benefits, when assessed against the policies in this Framework taken as a whole.”

- 4.4 Paragraph 61 supports Central Government’s aim of boosting the supply of homes and the importance of providing a sufficient amount and variety of housing land and that the needs of specific population groups are addressed.
- 4.5 There is also a requirement to deliver a wide choice of high-quality homes and plan for a mix of housing based on current and future trends.
- 4.6 Section 12 reinforces the Government’s importance regarding the need for good design which should contribute positively to making places better for people.
- 4.7 Paragraph 125 advises that planning decisions should promote the effective use of land in meeting the need for homes.
- 4.8 The following paragraph (126 (d)) advises that planning decisions should ‘promote and support the development of under-utilised land and buildings, especially if this would help to meet identified needs for housing where land supply is constrained and available sites could be used more effectively.....’.
- 4.9 Paragraph 135 states that decisions should ensure that new developments function well and add to the overall quality of the area, are visually attractive as a result of good architecture, layout and appropriate and effective landscaping, sympathetic to local character and history, including the surrounding built environment and landscape setting, establish or maintain a strong sense of place using the arrangement of spaces, building types and materials to create attractive, welcoming and distinctive places to live.
- 4.10 Recent changes proposed by the new government relevant to this submission include changes to assessing housing need via a new standard method as advised by the Deputy Prime Minister to ensure ‘the right kind of homes are delivered through our planning system as quickly as possible.’ This proposed change has resulted in an increase in the requirement to provide housing across the Island.

The Development Plan

- 4.11 The Island Plan Core Strategy (CS) seeks to establish certain spatial development principles and is the document that will set the overall planning framework for the Island until 2027. The document was adopted by the Council on 21 March 2012. Policies relevant to the consideration of this proposal are referenced below.



Extract from Core Strategy Map

- 4.12 The site lies within the Medina Valley Key Regeneration (KRA) boundary (black line). The Solent Protection Area buffer zone is highlighted in light blue and the adjacent listed building is identified with a red dot.
- 4.13 The Island Plan CS identifies the site as lying within the KRA as defined in its hierarchical approach, outside the recognised settlement boundary. Whilst reference is made to a Design SPD to aid consideration of new development, work on this document has not yet commenced and therefore there is no formal guidance on this issue.
- 4.14 Housing and spatial strategy policies SP1 and SP2, whilst out of date, are of relevance to a scheme involving the provision of a two bedroomed residential unit.
- 4.15 Policy SP5 (Environment) supports proposals that protect, conserve and /or enhance the Islands natural and historic environments.
- 4.16 Policy DM2 (Design Quality for New Development) seeks high quality and inclusive design to protect, conserve and enhance the existing environment whilst allowing change to take place.
- 4.17 Policy DM3 (Balanced Mix of Housing) supports the principle of providing an appropriate mix of housing types and sizes.
- 4.18 Policy DM11 (Historic and Built Environment) supports proposals which conserve and enhance the special character of the Islands historic and built environment.
- 4.19 The Council has published its 'submission version' of the Island Planning Strategy (IPS) which will in due course replace the Core Strategy. The document has been subject to public consultation and formal examination and adoption following submission and consent from the Secretary of State.
- 4.20 Following the Inspectors assessment the Council have agreed to increase the housing requirement in the Draft IPA from 453 dwellings per annum to 703 dwellings per annum.

Supplementary Planning Documents

- 4.21 Guidelines for Parking Provision as Part of New Development SPD (2017) requires two parking spaces for a three/four bedroomed property in this location.
- 4.22 Guidelines for Recycling and Refuse Storage in New Developments SPD (2017) expects proposals to demonstrate how they will provide for the storage of refuse and recyclable material.
- 4.23 Affordable Housing Contributions SPD (2017) sets out criteria outlining when financial contributions or on-site provision of such is required.
- 4.24 Solent Recreation Mitigation Strategy (2018) seeks to alleviate the impacts of development on coastal bird populations by requiring developer contributions to fund the implementation of management measures and monitoring.
- 4.25 The IOW Council expects all development that results in a net increase of residential units, including tourist units to demonstrate that the development would not cause harm to the Solent protected sites as a result of drainage resulting in a net increase in nutrients

5. PLANNING JUSTIFICATION

- 5.1 The material planning considerations relating to this application are considered to be;
 - (a) Development Plan Policy
 - (b) Impacts of the proposal on the character of the area
 - (d) Impacts on residential amenity
 - (e) Highways
 - (f) Previous decision on this site
 - (g) Other detailed matters

Development Plan Policy

- 5.2 Lying within the KRA and given the previous decision, the general approach of the LPA is to support in principle new residential development in these identified sustainable locations. There is therefore no fundamental need to address issues of local need, housing delivery performance or housing needs assessments to specifically justify the scheme in locational terms. It provides a small in demand residential unit as identified within various housing reports.

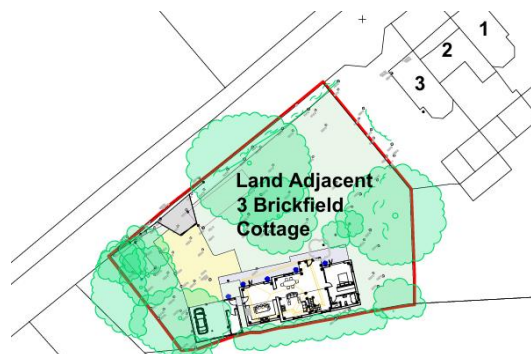
- 5.3 Therefore, provided the application does not conflict with the more detailed policies of the Local Planning Authority, then the application can be supported as provided for within the Core Strategy.

Impacts of the proposal on the character of the area

- 5.4 The immediate locality is characterised by sporadic established development and recognised as such as being located within the KRA boundary.
- 5.5 The introduction with a well-designed, appropriately sized modest dwelling on this piece of partly developed land, reasonably adjacent to the existing built environment will have no undue adverse impacts on the existing appearance of the locality. The new build will be of similar mass to its adjacent neighbour properties within the street scene.
- 5.6 The proposal in introducing a high quality modern dwelling unit in this location will enhance the character and quality of the environment and complement the context of the locality within which it will sit.
- 5.7 Given the mixed character of the built environment in this of the Island, the new build cannot reasonably be said to compromise any design considerations.
- 5.8 The development involving a well-designed attractive dwelling, reflective of the design approach of new residential units of appropriate architectural merit will have no impacts on the locality.
- 5.9 The proposal would cause no harm to the character or appearance of this area and would indeed complement the immediate built form by incorporating a new residential unit of sympathetic style and scale. The proposal is therefore not seen as being in conflict with Policy DM2 of the Core Strategy.

Impacts on residential amenity

- 5.10 The new build sites the building to the rear of the site whilst retaining sufficient distances to both side boundaries. Appropriate distances to the adjacent property is maintained with limited side openings at first floor level. There will therefore be no undue additional impacts from overdominance or loss of light or privacy



Proposed footprint

- 5.11 The design of the building and comfortable plot size will allow the construction of the proposed dwelling to take place without causing harm to residential amenity. No reasonable objection can therefore be raised in respect of this consideration.

Highways

- 5.12 Pre application advice received from Island Roads (Appendix A) was generally supportive, given an assessment of the previous consent and offer of highway gain.

Previous decision on this site

- 5.13 LPA support for the previously approved scheme (21/02386/FUL) was based on the lack of housing supply and poor delivery rates confirmed by Five Year Supply Updates and Housing Delivery Test results, which have not significantly improved in the interim.
- 5.14 In assessing the previous scheme the case officer stated, *'This is an established residential area that is reasonably well served by public transport links, albeit there would be a short walk along East Cowes Road to the bus route, in addition the site is located immediately adjacent to one of the cycle routes out of Newport. Despite the site not being within a wholly sustainable location, it would nonetheless offer alternative means of travel other than the car and therefore Officers are that this is an appropriate location for new residential development subject to the detail of the proposal.'*
- 5.15 No concerns were expressed in respect of design, impact on neighbours, highway or trees. Contributions in respect of affordable housing and Solent mitigation were provided and the confirmation of main drain connection removed any need for nitrate mitigation measures.
- 5.16 The siting allowed for parking and turning and the retention of the majority of natural growth with a condition requiring additional planting thus resulting in minimal impacts on the street scene.
- 5.17 The distance of 20 metres from the former host dwelling was considered acceptable as was the potential impact on the setting of this listed property.
- 5.18 It is the applicants view that the current proposal is considered to represent a significant improvement in design terms and offer to the streetscape over that previously approved (shown below).



Previous approval

Other detailed matters

Trees

- 5.19 An Arboricultural Impact Assessment was commissioned principally due to the mature trees on and adjacent to the site (Appendix B).
- 5.20 The author of the report concludes, '*the proposed development will not have a detrimental impact on trees on the site, that will influence the present or future amenity of the site or the surrounding area, provided the recommendations of this report are followed.*'
- 5.21 Furthermore, '*I have recommended that the prepared Tree Protection Plan is sufficient to provide protection to the trees on the site. As there are no works to be carried out within and Construction Exclusion Zone there no requirement for an Arboricultural Method Statement.*'
- 5.22 The Tree Survey Plan (below) indicates that only three minor tree/shrub specimens require removal, otherwise existing trees and screens are retained.



Tree Survey

Ecology

- 5.23 There is no recognised ecological interest in this site.

Biodiversity Net Gain

- 5.24 As the proposal relates to a self-build project the proposal is exempt from any requirement in respect of this issue.

Flood Risk

- 5.25 The site is not identified on the Environment Agency data base as being at risk from flooding (FZ1).

Other matters

- 5.26 There are no known constraints relating to contamination, archaeological issues or ground conditions.
- 5.27 Natural England has published guidance on the need to achieve nutrient neutrality in respect of potential impacts on European protected sites, in this instance the Solent SPA and Maritime SAC, 'Advice on Achieving Nutrient Neutrality for New Development in the Solent Region, updated in June 2020.
- 5.28 However, as Southern Water confirm that the locality is served by Sandown WwTW (email accompanies application – Appendix C), there is no need to address potential nitrate nutrient impacts within the Solent.
- 5.29 Given that the proposal provides for an additional dwelling, payments in respect of Affordable Housing and Solent Mitigation are applicable in this case and the applicant is willing to enter into the necessary legal agreement to commit to such payments..

6. PLANNING BALANCE/CONCLUSION

- 6.1 The proposal involves the introduction of a modest detached dwellinghouse within a previously agreed reasonably sustainable location providing a small residential unit that meets an identified Island need.
- 6.2 Provided matters relating to detail are considered satisfactory then the proposal can be supported accordingly.
- 6.3 Turning to the relevant detailed issues:
- The scheme does not materially impact on the character or appearance of the area given that the locality is relatively well screened as is the adjacent existing development,

- The proposal takes the opportunity to provide for an additional two bed dwelling helping in some small way in meeting the islands housing needs,
- This proposal respects the integrity of the site and successfully works within its constraints and the comments contained within this statement support the view that a new build dwelling as proposed can be constructed here without harm to the character of the locality or neighbouring listed property or residents,
- No identifiable harm will be caused to residential amenity as required by CS Policy DM2,
- The access and parking arrangements are of a more than suitable standard to accommodate the unit and its associated vehicular activity representing a safe and compliant access,
- Matters relating to trees, drainage and flood risk are satisfactorily addressed within information accompanying this submission,
- The design of the dwelling represents a significant improvement in architectural quality over the previously approved functional bungalow unit on this site.

6.4 The support of the LPA is duly requested.